

Point of View: Whose Story Is It?

About 2 weeks. 8 lessons. Anchor text: "The Seat by the Window," an original short story (about 700 words). Mara, a sixth grader, thinks her best friend Theo is avoiding her on the bus.

Big idea

Who tells a story shapes what we know and how we feel. Change the narrator, and the same events can look very different.

Learning goals

1. Identify the narrator and the point of view.
2. Explain how the narrator's perspective shapes events.
3. Cite text evidence to support an idea.
4. Rewrite a scene from another character's view.

Lesson by lesson

Lesson	Focus	Activity
1	Every story has a teller	Compare two short accounts of the same lunchroom spill.
2	Who is telling this story?	Read the story. Find narrator clues in the Wednesday scene.
3	Limited or omniscient?	Retell one moment three ways: first person, limited, and omniscient.
4	What the narrator knows	Two-column chart: what Mara sees, and what she thinks it means.
5	Bias and inference	Find three clues Mara misreads. Infer what Theo is really doing.
6	Proving it with evidence	Write the text-evidence paragraph: claim, evidence, explanation.
7	Switching the lens	Plan a scene from Theo's point of view. Start the rewrite.
8	Share and reflect	Finish the rewrite, read it to a partner, and write a reflection.

Assessment plan

- **Along the way:** quick-writes, exit tickets, clue chart.
- **Text-evidence paragraph (Lesson 6):** how does Mara's point of view shape what we believe about Theo? A claim, two quotes, and an explanation.
- **Creative rewrite (Lessons 7 and 8):** retell one scene from Theo's point of view (or another character's). Same events, new narrator. 250 to 400 words.
- **Reflection:** 3 to 5 sentences. What changed when the narrator changed?

Vocabulary

narrator: the voice that tells the story

first person: the narrator is in the story and says "I"

third person limited: an outside narrator who knows one character's thoughts

third person omniscient: an outside narrator who knows every character's thoughts

perspective: how a character sees events

bias: a leaning that tilts how someone sees things

text evidence: exact words that back up an idea

inference: a conclusion built from clues